NINJAS STEM FOUNDATION

Student Recruitment, Admission & Renewal Policy

POLICY ID NSF-SP-01 | STATUS Proposed for Board approval | EFFECTIVE DATE _____

1. Purpose and Scope

Ninjas STEM Foundation ("NSF" or the "Foundation") provides educational opportunities through robotics, engineering, programming, mentorship, and related STEM activities.

This Policy establishes fair, consistent, and transparent procedures for student recruitment, admission, evaluation, renewal, and participation decisions.

It applies to students seeking or holding positions in Foundation-operated competitive robotics teams. Public workshops, short-term educational events, and independently operated teams receiving NSF mentorship may use separate program-specific procedures approved by the Foundation.

Participation in an NSF educational program does not automatically confer corporate membership, a Board position, or organizational voting rights.

2. Program Oversight and Decision-Making

The Board of Directors oversees NSF educational programs and approves their overall capacity, eligibility requirements, and participation policies.

The Head Coach or designated program leader is responsible for student instruction, evaluation, development plans, and recommendations regarding admission and renewal.

Unless validly delegated under the governing documents, the Board makes final decisions concerning competitive-team admission, renewal, and midseason termination.

Student assignments, including driving, coding, building, documentation, and outreach, are operational and educational roles subject to coaching supervision.

3. Recruitment and Available Positions

NSF seeks to provide meaningful educational opportunities to students from the broader community.

When recruiting new team participants, NSF shall identify actual available positions and make information reasonably accessible through appropriate channels, including its website, schools, libraries, community programs, and other outreach opportunities.

Recruitment information should describe:

- Eligibility, age or grade requirements, and available positions.
- Expected meeting schedules, participation commitments, and learning objectives.
- Application and evaluation procedures.
- Any required charges, financial assistance options, and relevant deadlines.
- The number of positions available, where practicable.

Recruitment does not guarantee admission. NSF may decline to fill a position if the available candidates do not meet applicable requirements or adequate resources are unavailable.

4. Application and Admission

Applications shall be evaluated using disclosed, relevant, and consistently applied criteria.

These may include:

- Eligibility under applicable competition rules.
- Genuine student interest and willingness to learn.
- Availability to participate in the expected program schedule.
- Readiness for the particular educational program.
- Teamwork, responsible conduct, and ability to follow safety procedures.
- Available supervision, equipment, instructional resources, and team capacity.

Prior robotics experience may be considered when relevant to a particular position, but beginners shall not be excluded solely because they lack advanced technical skills.

Donations, parental Board or officer positions, fundraising activity, or personal relationships shall not purchase or guarantee admission.

The Foundation shall provide appropriate consideration of accessibility and reasonable accommodation requests.

5. Assessment and Selection

The Head Coach or designated reviewers may use age-appropriate interviews, introductory sessions, practical exercises, or other educational assessments.

Assessments should evaluate learning potential, interest, collaboration, and readiness—not merely existing technical achievement.

A student's introductory visit or assessment does not constitute admission unless NSF issues and the parent or guardian accepts a participation offer.

The Head Coach shall document recommendations and the relevant reasons. Final admission decisions shall be approved by the authorized decision-maker and communicated to the family.

6. Participation Offers

Each competitive-team offer shall identify:

- The student and applicable team or program.
- The covered season and any defined postseason extension.
- Expected attendance and educational commitments.
- Applicable policies and conduct expectations.
- Any required fees, cancellation terms, or assistance arrangements.
- The designated contact for questions or concerns.

A parent or legal guardian must accept the offer before the minor student's enrollment begins.

Media consent is separate and optional.

A student is not guaranteed a permanent technical role, driving position, presentation assignment, or subsequent-season placement.

7. Student Evaluation and Development

The Head Coach shall establish reasonable, age-appropriate expectations for student assignments.

Evaluation may consider technical understanding, student-created work, accuracy, preparation, practice, reliability, teamwork, safe conduct, and the ability to learn from feedback.

Expectations should be communicated before an assignment is evaluated.

Students shall receive constructive feedback and reasonable opportunities to develop their skills. Evaluations should consider relevant instruction, experience, approved absences, and appropriate accommodations.

Student work must comply with applicable student-centered competition requirements. Adults may teach and provide appropriate guidance but shall not substitute their work or decisions for those reserved to students.

A student's value to the program shall not be judged solely by competition results, awards, or rankings.

8. Role Assignment and Reassignment

The Head Coach may assign, rotate, reassign, or discontinue operational student roles based on readiness, performance, safety, educational objectives, and team needs.

An assignment may be changed promptly when necessary for an upcoming competition, presentation, or other confirmed commitment.

The reason for a material reassignment should be explained and documented appropriately.

Reassignment of an operational role does not, by itself, terminate the student's enrollment.

For recurring performance concerns, the Foundation should provide documented feedback and a reasonable improvement opportunity before recommending final termination, except where immediate protective action is warranted.

9. Annual Renewal

Competitive-team participation is ordinarily established for a defined season.

Continued participation in a subsequent season requires review of available capacity, educational needs, student interests, participation, progress, and applicable eligibility.

The Head Coach shall provide recommendations based on documented, relevant criteria.

The authorized decision-maker may approve renewal, conditional renewal, waitlisting, or nonrenewal.

NSF should communicate decisions sufficiently before the following season to permit families to plan.

Prior participation, parental service, donations, or a previously held student role do not guarantee renewal.

A director or decision-maker with a material personal conflict concerning an individual student shall follow the Foundation's conflict-of-interest procedures.

10. Voluntary Withdrawal

A parent or legal guardian may withdraw a minor student through written notice, including attributable electronic communication, to the designated Foundation contact.

The notice should identify the student, program, and intended effective date.

Where an oral or ambiguous communication suggests withdrawal, the recipient shall promptly document the communication and request clarification or confirmation. An express condition shall not be omitted from the record.

A conditional departure proposal shall not be recharacterized as an unconditional withdrawal. Conversely, proposing a refund does not itself establish a repayment obligation or guarantee indefinite continued participation.

The student may stop attending while clarification is obtained. NSF shall not compel continued participation.

Student withdrawal does not automatically end any separately held adult Board, officer, or volunteer position.

11. Suspension, Termination, and Reconsideration

Before final involuntary termination of competitive-team participation, NSF shall ordinarily provide written notice identifying the relevant grounds, an opportunity for the student and parent to respond, and review by an appropriately authorized and unconflicted decision-maker.

Immediate temporary restrictions may be imposed for documented safety or serious disruption concerns, with prompt further review.

A family may request reconsideration based on material factual errors, inconsistent application of policy, procedural deficiencies, or relevant new information.

Procedural details and response periods shall be established in the Student Participation SOP.

Good-faith concerns, lawful reports, or decisions not to make voluntary donations shall not independently constitute grounds for adverse participation decisions.

12. Records and Implementation

The Foundation shall maintain appropriate records of applications, offers, accepted participation terms, evaluations, material decisions, notices, and reconsideration requests.

Student information shall be handled under applicable privacy and records policies.

This Policy operates prospectively. It does not retroactively determine or change the legal effect of previous withdrawals, admissions, assignments, agreements, or disputes.

The Board shall review this Policy periodically and approve any material revisions under the applicable governing procedures.